

Stage-by-Stage Impact of Blind Hiring

1 Summary

Core Thesis:

The traditional justification for blind hiring is built on the assumption of *in-group favoritism* — the premise that majority gatekeepers harbor implicit biases against underrepresented minorities (URMs) and systematically favor candidates who look like themselves. Blind hiring is theoretically deployed to level the playing field by removing demographic noise'' and revealing pure technicalsignal.''

Our experiment demonstrates the *exact opposite* is occurring in modern software engineering hiring.

Because majority gatekeepers organically apply an informal out-group premium'' to minority candidates, blinding demographic information fundamentally reshuffles hiring outcomes --- mechanically harming URMs and boosting White Males. Furthermore, this informal bias is highly elastic to formal corporate policy. When firms lack explicit diversity mandates, individual evaluators engage in \emph{compensatory bias}, informally boosting minority scores. Enforcing blind hiring in these environments destroys this potential safety net. Finally, despite claims that demographics are distractingnoise,''' blinding resumes yielded *no improvement* in the actual technical quality of the selected candidates.

2 Overall Treatment Effect on Evaluations (Reshuffling)

- **The Finding:** Blinding demographic information during candidate evaluation *reshuffles* hiring outcomes by disrupting a pre-existing system of *demographic premiums and penalties*.
- **The Winners: White Males.** Evaluated by Engineers, White Male overall scores mechanically rise by **+8.5%** of a SD under blinding.
- **The Losers: Hispanic candidates.** When stripped of their demographic identity, Hispanic Male scores plunge by **-11.5%** of a SD (evaluated by HR), and Hispanic Female scores fall by **-6.9%** of a SD (evaluated by Engineers).
- **The Takeaway:** Blind hiring removes a *baseline penalty* that White Males were experiencing in the non-blind evaluations, while simultaneously stripping Hispanic candidates of an (*diversity*) *premium*.
- **Caveat:** Hiring is often an *ordinal ranking* problem — one candidate’s gain corresponds to another’s lost opportunity — so the absence of statistical significance on a given row does not mean the corresponding group is unaffected by blinding.

Panel A: HR

	Coding (Z)	Fit (Z)	Stay (Z)	Overall (Z)	Advance (0/1)
White Male	0.038 (0.056)	0.073 (0.057)	0.072 (0.059)	0.037 (0.057)	-0.006 (0.050)
White Female	0.020 (0.046)	0.010 (0.053)	0.022 (0.065)	0.013 (0.051)	0.003 (0.049)
Asian Male	0.032 (0.052)	0.029 (0.061)	-0.050 (0.061)	0.015 (0.059)	-0.022 (0.049)
Asian Female	0.020 (0.052)	-0.011 (0.056)	0.028 (0.062)	-0.023 (0.048)	-0.019 (0.052)
Hispanic Male	-0.142*** (0.050)	-0.056 (0.053)	-0.084 (0.062)	-0.115** (0.048)	-0.047 (0.049)
Hispanic Female	0.040 (0.058)	-0.049 (0.067)	0.013 (0.074)	0.087* (0.052)	-0.001 (0.056)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	×	×	×	×	×
Respondent Characteristics	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	2466	2430	2394	2466	2466
R ²	0.398	0.315	0.196	0.423	0.229
Adj. R ²	0.383	0.297	0.176	0.408	0.210

* p < 0.1, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01

Standard errors clustered by respondent.

Note on Interpreting Coefficients: The underlying regression uses Blind resumes as the reference category, so raw coefficients capture (nonblind – blind) or the effect of being blinded for each demographic on standardized overall evaluation scores. We then multiply by -1 to report (blind – nonblind), aligning the sign convention with the standard “effect of blinding” framing. Positive coefficient ⇒ blinding raises the score for that demographic.

Panel B: Engineer

	Coding (Z)	Fit (Z)	Stay (Z)	Overall (Z)
White Male	0.072** (0.029)	0.040 (0.041)	0.045 (0.049)	0.085*** (0.028)
White Female	0.028 (0.031)	0.046 (0.045)	0.023 (0.053)	0.023 (0.036)
Asian Male	-0.071** (0.028)	0.083* (0.046)	0.002 (0.050)	-0.018 (0.028)
Asian Female	0.003 (0.029)	-0.099** (0.042)	-0.053 (0.048)	-0.029 (0.029)
Hispanic Male	0.009 (0.027)	0.023 (0.037)	0.042 (0.054)	-0.003 (0.030)
Hispanic Female	-0.050* (0.027)	-0.101** (0.042)	-0.067 (0.059)	-0.069** (0.034)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	×	×	×	×
Respondent Characteristics	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	2772	2772	2736	2772
R ²	0.788	0.571	0.345	0.743
Adj. R ²	0.784	0.562	0.331	0.737

* p < 0.1, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01

3 Rejecting In-Group Favoritism (Why White Males Win)

- **The Context:** White Males constitute the overwhelming majority of Software Engineer evaluators in this sample (and the industry at large). *Legacy theories assume this group favors its own.*
- **The Finding:** Our experiment shows that the modern tech industry actually operates on a preference for the *out-group* (or preference for *under-represented groups*). Because White Males make up the majority of the evaluator pool, their behavior drives the aggregate metrics. When you blind resumes, the scores of concordant (race/gender) applicants evaluated by Engineers actually rise by **+6.9%** of a SD ($p < 0.05$) while the scores of discordant applicants fall by **-0.9%** of a SD ($p < 0.05$).
- **The Takeaway:** This shows that, under non-blinded evaluations, the majority gatekeepers were *actively penalizing* candidates who looked like themselves and assigning a *premium to evaluation scores of minority candidates*. Enforcing blind hiring doesn't stop discrimination against minorities; it stops the White Male majority from systematically boosting them. This explains why, in our experiment, White Male applicants are the primary beneficiaries of blind hiring: they are “rescued” from the baseline penalty imposed by their own demographic engineer peers.

3.1 By Concordant Race (matched on detailed Asian Ethnicity)

	Panel A: HR (N = 137)					Panel B: Engineer (N = 154)			
	Coding	Fit	Stay	Overall	Advance	Coding	Fit	Stay	Overall
Concordant Applicant	-0.011 (0.039)	-0.001 (0.040)	-0.041 (0.047)	-0.020 (0.042)	-0.042 (0.046)	0.032 (0.021)	0.046 (0.031)	0.025 (0.039)	0.045* (0.023)
Nonconcordant Applicant	0.004 (0.014)	0.000 (0.014)	0.014 (0.017)	0.007 (0.015)	-0.007 (0.044)	-0.010 (0.006)	-0.014 (0.009)	-0.008 (0.012)	-0.014* (0.007)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	×	×	×	×	×	×	×	×	×
Respondent Characteristics	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	2466	2430	2394	2466	2466	2772	2772	2736	2772
R ²	0.396	0.314	0.195	0.421	0.229	0.787	0.569	0.344	0.742
Adj. R ²	0.382	0.297	0.176	0.407	0.211	0.783	0.560	0.331	0.737

* p < 0.1, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01

Standard errors clustered by respondent.

Note: Concordance is defined at the detailed race level: Asian respondents are matched at the sub-ethnicity level (Chinese / Indian). Respondents whose race is not represented in the applicant pool (e.g., Black, Other; Korean / Japanese / other-Asian whose sub-ethnicity is not Chinese or Indian) are treated as always-discordant in nonblind.

Coefficients are flipped so positive $\Rightarrow$ blinding raises the score for that concordance group relative to the nonblind outcome.

3.2 By Concordant Gender

	Panel A: HR (N = 137)					Panel B: Engineer (N = 154)			
	Coding	Fit	Stay	Overall	Advance	Coding	Fit	Stay	Overall
Concordant Applicant	-0.018 (0.026)	-0.024 (0.029)	0.007 (0.035)	-0.010 (0.027)	-0.022 (0.047)	0.005 (0.012)	0.033* (0.019)	0.036 (0.028)	0.029* (0.015)
Nonconcordant Applicant	0.017 (0.024)	0.021 (0.026)	-0.007 (0.031)	0.009 (0.025)	-0.010 (0.043)	-0.005 (0.013)	-0.034* (0.019)	-0.037 (0.029)	-0.030* (0.016)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	×	×	×	×	×	×	×	×	×
Respondent Characteristics	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	2466	2430	2394	2466	2466	2772	2772	2736	2772
R ²	0.396	0.314	0.195	0.421	0.229	0.787	0.569	0.345	0.742
Adj. R ²	0.382	0.298	0.176	0.407	0.211	0.783	0.560	0.331	0.737

* p < 0.1, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01

Standard errors clustered by respondent.

Note: Respondents whose gender is not represented in the applicant pool (e.g., Non-binary, Other) are treated as always-discordant in nonblind, since the applicant names are exclusively Male or Female.

Coefficients are flipped so positive $\Rightarrow$ blinding raises the score for that concordance group relative to the nonblind outcome.

3.3 By Concordant Race and Gender

	Panel A: HR (N = 137)					Panel B: Engineer (N = 154)			
	Coding	Fit	Stay	Overall	Advance	Coding	Fit	Stay	Overall
Concordant Applicant	-0.030 (0.058)	0.008 (0.065)	0.018 (0.078)	-0.057 (0.063)	-0.022 (0.058)	0.004 (0.032)	0.003 (0.044)	-0.011 (0.050)	0.040 (0.028)
Nonconcordant Applicant	0.005 (0.010)	-0.001 (0.012)	-0.003 (0.014)	0.010 (0.011)	-0.015 (0.043)	-0.001 (0.007)	-0.001 (0.009)	0.002 (0.010)	-0.008 (0.006)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	×	×	×	×	×	×	×	×	×
Respondent Characteristics	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	2466	2430	2394	2466	2466	2772	2772	2736	2772
R ²	0.396	0.314	0.195	0.421	0.228	0.787	0.569	0.344	0.742
Adj. R ²	0.382	0.297	0.176	0.408	0.211	0.783	0.560	0.331	0.737

* p < 0.1, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01

Standard errors clustered by respondent.

Note: Concordance is defined as race-gender match at the broad level (Asian respondents are matched at the broad Asian level rather than by detailed sub-ethnicity). Respondents whose race or gender is not represented in the applicant pool (e.g., Black, Other; Non-binary, Other-gender) are treated as always-discordant in nonblind.

Coefficients are flipped so positive $\Rightarrow$ blinding raises the score for that concordance group relative to the nonblind outcome.

3.4 By Concordant Race and Gender (matched on detailed Asian Ethnicity)

	Panel A: HR (N = 137)					Panel B: Engineer (N = 154)			
	Coding	Fit	Stay	Overall	Advance	Coding	Fit	Stay	Overall
Concordant Applicant	-0.030 (0.064)	0.020 (0.067)	0.019 (0.087)	-0.076 (0.068)	-0.029 (0.059)	0.037 (0.029)	0.047 (0.047)	0.049 (0.060)	0.069** (0.032)
Nonconcordant Applicant	0.004 (0.009)	-0.003 (0.010)	-0.003 (0.012)	0.011 (0.010)	-0.014 (0.043)	-0.005 (0.004)	-0.007 (0.006)	-0.007 (0.008)	-0.009** (0.004)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	×	×	×	×	×	×	×	×	×
Respondent Characteristics	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	2466	2430	2394	2466	2466	2772	2772	2736	2772
R ²	0.396	0.314	0.195	0.421	0.229	0.787	0.569	0.344	0.742
Adj. R ²	0.382	0.297	0.176	0.408	0.211	0.783	0.560	0.331	0.737

* p < 0.1, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01

Standard errors clustered by respondent.

Note: Concordance is defined at the detailed race-gender level: applicants are Chinese, Indian, White, or Hispanic (by gender). Respondents whose detailed race-gender is not represented in the applicant pool (e.g., Korean / Japanese / other-Asian sub-ethnicities; Black, Other-race; Non-binary, Other-gender) are treated as always-discordant in nonblind.

Coefficients are flipped so positive $\Rightarrow$ blinding raises the score for that concordance group relative to the nonblind outcome.

4 Institutional Substitution (Firm Policy vs. Individual Bias)

- **The Puzzle of Individual Ideology (Section 4.1):** If one merely examines the two-way relationship between an evaluator’s personal DEI priority and their evaluation scores, the effects appear surprisingly *muted and statistically noisy*. At first glance, one might incorrectly conclude that personal ideology has little impact on how blind hiring reshuffles outcomes.
 - **Compensatory Bias** (Firms with NO Diversity Mandate, see [red lines](#)): When a firm lacks an explicit objective policy targeting URMs, highly pro-DEI HR professionals engage in *compensatory bias*. They fill the perceived institutional void by informally inflating minority candidates’ scores in the baseline.
 - **Institutional Crowding-Out** (Firms WITH a Diversity Mandate, see [blue lines](#)): Conversely, when the firm explicitly mandates URM targeting, this formal policy *crowds out* the evaluator’s informal efforts. The pro-DEI HR professional, when combined with institutional DEI targeting policy, *mutes* from assigning premium to under-represented minority’s scores.
- (Note *Divergence between HR and Engineer Results*, particularly in Triple Interaction.)

4.1 By Individual DEI / Diversity Preferences

- **Index A** — equal-weight average (1/5 each) of five z-scored items: the four stated DEI views plus the revealed-priority ranking of “Diversity and Representation” from the seven-goals question.
- **Index B** — first principal component of the same five items.

Per Race-Gender				
	Panel A: HR		Panel B: Engineer	
	Index A (1)	Index B (2)	Index A (3)	Index B (4)
White Male	0.040 (0.056)	0.040 (0.056)	0.086*** (0.028)	0.085*** (0.028)
White Female	0.014 (0.051)	0.014 (0.051)	0.023 (0.035)	0.023 (0.036)
Asian Male	0.016 (0.060)	0.016 (0.060)	-0.017 (0.028)	-0.017 (0.028)
Asian Female	-0.023 (0.048)	-0.023 (0.048)	-0.030 (0.029)	-0.030 (0.029)
Hispanic Male	-0.113** (0.048)	-0.113** (0.048)	-0.004 (0.029)	-0.004 (0.030)
Hispanic Female	0.091* (0.050)	0.091* (0.050)	-0.070** (0.033)	-0.070** (0.033)
White Male × DEI Index	0.098 (0.079)	0.099 (0.079)	0.009 (0.032)	0.009 (0.033)
White Female × DEI Index	-0.014 (0.051)	-0.018 (0.052)	0.039 (0.047)	0.036 (0.047)
Asian Male × DEI Index	-0.007 (0.064)	-0.005 (0.064)	0.015 (0.026)	0.012 (0.026)
Asian Female × DEI Index	0.009 (0.047)	0.007 (0.047)	-0.005 (0.022)	-0.005 (0.022)
Hispanic Male × DEI Index	0.020 (0.063)	0.022 (0.063)	-0.077*** (0.029)	-0.073** (0.029)
Hispanic Female × DEI Index	-0.136** (0.062)	-0.135** (0.062)	0.038 (0.034)	0.038 (0.034)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	×	×	×	×
Respondent Characteristics	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	2,466	2,466	2,772	2,772
R ²	0.425	0.425	0.743	0.743
Adjusted R ²	0.409	0.409	0.737	0.737

The DEI Index level effect is included in each regression.

Standard errors clustered by respondent.

Positive coefficient ⇒ effect of blinding raises the score for that group.

Per URM Cut				
	Panel A: HR		Panel B: Engineer	
	Index A (1)	Index B (2)	Index A (3)	Index B (4)
URM	-0.013 (0.019)	-0.013 (0.019)	-0.019* (0.010)	-0.019* (0.010)
Non-URM	0.027 (0.037)	0.027 (0.037)	0.036* (0.019)	0.036* (0.019)
URM × DEI Index	-0.025 (0.023)	-0.025 (0.023)	-0.006 (0.012)	-0.005 (0.012)
Non-URM × DEI Index	0.048 (0.044)	0.049 (0.044)	0.011 (0.022)	0.010 (0.022)
Per URM Cut — Axis Decomposition				
	Panel A: HR		Panel B: Engineer	
	Index A (1)	Index B (2)	Index A (3)	Index B (4)
Male (non-hispanic)	0.026 (0.037)	0.026 (0.037)	0.036* (0.019)	0.036* (0.019)
Female (non-hispanic)	-0.006 (0.028)	-0.006 (0.028)	-0.005 (0.020)	-0.005 (0.020)
Hispanic	-0.020 (0.035)	-0.020 (0.035)	-0.033 (0.021)	-0.033 (0.021)
Male (non-hispanic) × DEI Index	0.048 (0.044)	0.049 (0.043)	0.011 (0.022)	0.010 (0.022)
Female (non-hispanic) × DEI Index	-0.001 (0.031)	-0.004 (0.032)	0.015 (0.024)	0.014 (0.024)
Hispanic × DEI Index	-0.048 (0.046)	-0.047 (0.046)	-0.028 (0.019)	-0.025 (0.019)

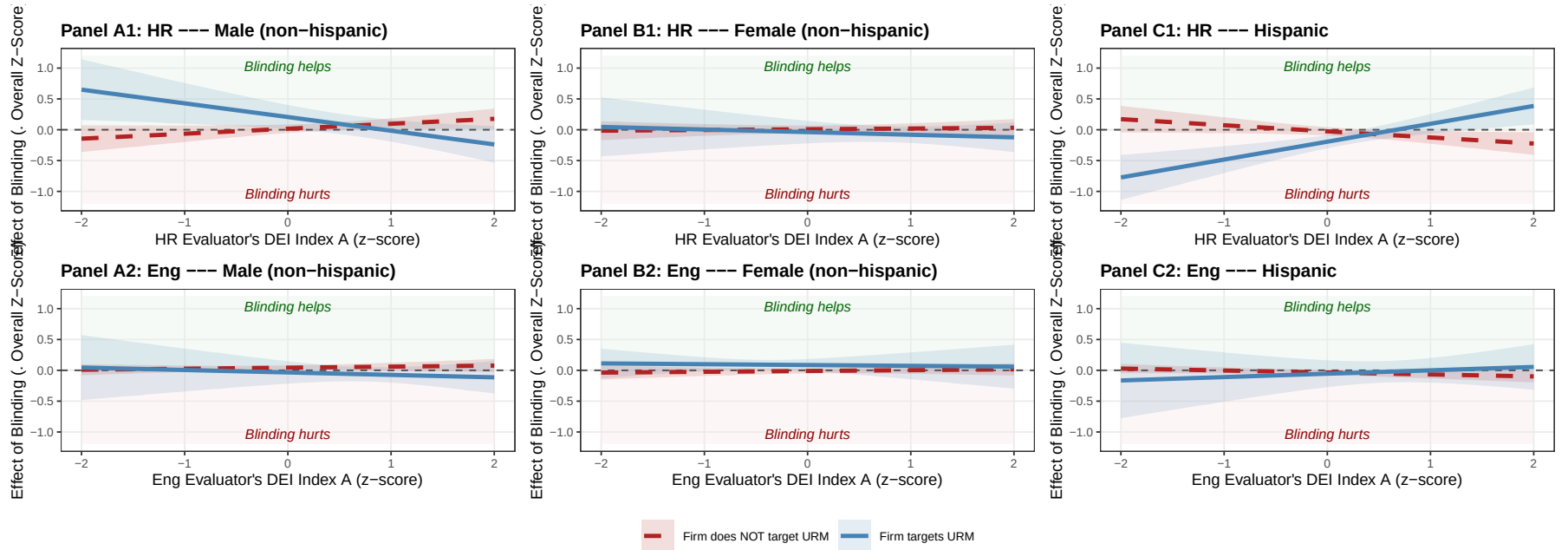
FE structure, controls, N, and DEI Index level effect as in the left-side table.

Positive coefficient ⇒ effect of blinding raises the score for that group.

4.2 (Triple Interaction Models) By Whether the Firm Targets URM $\times$ Respondent's DEI Priority

Index A — URM Axis (full triple)		
	HR (1)	Eng (2)
Male (NH)	0.016 (0.035)	0.043** (0.019)
Female (NH)	0.008 (0.031)	-0.010 (0.021)
Hispanic	-0.026 (0.034)	-0.035 (0.021)
Male (NH) $\times$ DEI	0.080* (0.046)	0.017 (0.023)
Female (NH) $\times$ DEI	0.012 (0.034)	0.013 (0.025)
Hispanic $\times$ DEI	-0.099** (0.048)	-0.032 (0.020)
Male (NH) $\times$ FT	0.190* (0.107)	-0.077 (0.095)
Female (NH) $\times$ FT	-0.047 (0.100)	0.096* (0.054)
Hispanic $\times$ FT	-0.168*** (0.064)	-0.020 (0.113)
Male (NH) $\times$ FT $\times$ DEI	-0.303*** (0.101)	-0.056 (0.097)
Female (NH) $\times$ FT $\times$ DEI	-0.054 (0.090)	-0.026 (0.077)
Hispanic $\times$ FT $\times$ DEI	0.389*** (0.095)	0.087 (0.118)

URM-axis triple regression with Index A as the DEI proxy. FE: Resume (Content) $\checkmark$, Display Position $\checkmark$, Respondent $\times$, Respondent Characteristics $\checkmark$. SE clustered by respondent. *Firm Targets URM* = *firm_targets_female* OR *firm_targets_hispanic*. Positive coefficient $\Rightarrow$ blinding raises the score for that group.



Top row: HR evaluators (Panels A1, B1, C1). Bottom row: Engineer evaluators (Panels A2, B2, C2). Lines: predicted effect of blinding on each group's overall score as a function of the rater's DEI Index A; shaded bands are 95% CIs from the linear combination of axis-triple coefficients (SE clustered by respondent).

4.3 (Triple Interaction Models) By Respondent's Priority for DEI $\times$ Firm Attention on DEI

Index A — Per Race-Gender (triple terms)			Index B — Per Race-Gender (triple terms)		
	HR (1)	Eng (2)		HR (1)	Eng (2)
White Male $\times$ DEI Index $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	-0.184* (0.100)	0.024 (0.030)	White Male $\times$ DEI Index $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	-0.193* (0.108)	0.025 (0.031)
White Female $\times$ DEI Index $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	0.010 (0.073)	0.011 (0.043)	White Female $\times$ DEI Index $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	0.012 (0.078)	0.001 (0.042)
Asian Male $\times$ DEI Index $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	-0.185** (0.072)	0.003 (0.029)	Asian Male $\times$ DEI Index $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	-0.189** (0.075)	0.006 (0.028)
Asian Female $\times$ DEI Index $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	0.029 (0.066)	-0.024 (0.030)	Asian Female $\times$ DEI Index $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	0.030 (0.067)	-0.021 (0.029)
Hispanic Male $\times$ DEI Index $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	0.138* (0.070)	-0.049** (0.023)	Hispanic Male $\times$ DEI Index $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	0.135* (0.074)	-0.049** (0.023)
Hispanic Female $\times$ DEI Index $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	0.181** (0.087)	0.041 (0.049)	Hispanic Female $\times$ DEI Index $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	0.193** (0.087)	0.044 (0.048)
Index A — URM Axis (full triple)			Index B — URM Axis (full triple)		
	HR (1)	Eng (2)		HR (1)	Eng (2)
Male (non-hispanic)	0.085** (0.039)	0.016 (0.019)	Male (non-hispanic)	0.087** (0.039)	0.015 (0.019)
Female (non-hispanic)	-0.016 (0.036)	0.004 (0.024)	Female (non-hispanic)	-0.017 (0.036)	0.006 (0.024)
Hispanic	-0.069** (0.034)	-0.022 (0.026)	Hispanic	-0.070** (0.034)	-0.023 (0.026)
Male (non-hispanic) $\times$ DEI Index	0.072* (0.036)	0.041 (0.031)	Male (non-hispanic) $\times$ DEI Index	0.070* (0.036)	0.040 (0.033)
Female (non-hispanic) $\times$ DEI Index	0.001 (0.037)	0.002 (0.033)	Female (non-hispanic) $\times$ DEI Index	-0.003 (0.037)	-0.001 (0.032)
Hispanic $\times$ DEI Index	-0.079* (0.043)	-0.047 (0.037)	Hispanic $\times$ DEI Index	-0.073* (0.043)	-0.043 (0.038)
Male (non-hispanic) $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	0.069 (0.052)	-0.017 (0.024)	Male (non-hispanic) $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	0.081 (0.055)	-0.017 (0.024)
Female (non-hispanic) $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	-0.057 (0.038)	-0.007 (0.026)	Female (non-hispanic) $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	-0.057 (0.041)	-0.005 (0.026)
Hispanic $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	-0.011 (0.048)	0.027 (0.027)	Hispanic $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	-0.023 (0.051)	0.025 (0.027)
Male (non-hispanic) $\times$ DEI $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	-0.185*** (0.057)	0.013 (0.022)	Male (non-hispanic) $\times$ DEI $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	-0.192*** (0.058)	0.015 (0.023)
Female (non-hispanic) $\times$ DEI $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	0.021 (0.045)	-0.008 (0.024)	Female (non-hispanic) $\times$ DEI $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	0.023 (0.047)	-0.011 (0.022)
Hispanic $\times$ DEI $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	0.164*** (0.060)	-0.005 (0.024)	Hispanic $\times$ DEI $\times$ Firm DEI Attn	0.170*** (0.060)	-0.005 (0.025)

Top panel: per-race-gender triple (only the 6 triple terms shown). Bottom panel: URM-axis triple (full 12 coefficients), where Male (non-hispanic) = WM+AM, Female (non-hispanic) = WF+AF, Hispanic = HM+HF. The URM-cut block is omitted: it is implied by the axis block (URM = Female (non-hispanic) + Hispanic; Non-URM = Male (non-hispanic)). Both blocks share identical specification: Resume (Content) FE ✓, Display Position FE ✓, Respondent FE ×, Respondent Characteristics ✓. Standard errors clustered by respondent.

Note: Firm DEI Attn proxy is `firm_dei_attention_z` (within-cell z-score of the equal-weight average of `firm_attention_race_z` and `firm_attention_gender_z`).

Positive coefficient $\Rightarrow$ effect of blinding raises the score for that group.

5 Treatment Effect on Productivity of Hired (The Efficiency Myth)

If blind hiring reshuffles outcomes (Sections 2–4), proponents might argue it is a necessary trade-off for strict meritocracy and better technical hires. Our results show otherwise.

- **Signal Extraction Remains Flat (S5.1.):** Removing demographic information (or noise) does *not* meaningfully improve their ability to identify top ability candidates.
- **Quality of Hires Does Not Improve (S5.2.):** Blind hiring has a *null* effect on the actual coding quality of the hired cohort.

5.1 Does Blinding Lead to More Accurate Coding Evaluations?

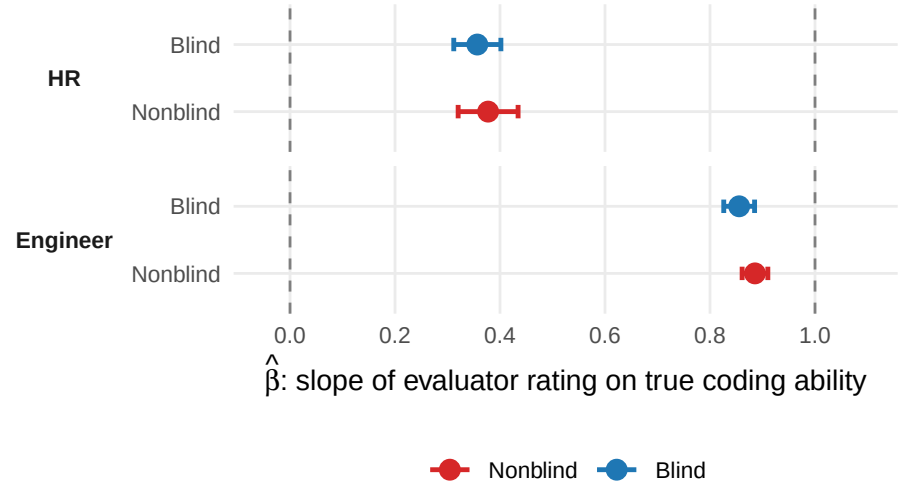
Takeaway: Evaluators do extract signal about candidates’ actual coding ability — Engineers much more strongly than HR, consistent with Engineers seeing the code while HR sees only the resume. Blinding, however, does *not* meaningfully change this signal-extraction ability in either role: the `true_coding_z × blind` interaction is small, negative, and statistically insignificant for both HR and Engineers. If blinding — which in our experiment amounts to removing random, uninformative demographic noise — improved signal-extraction ability, we would expect a positive and statistically significant interaction term. In short, blinding *reshuffles* who receives high scores (Section 1.1) but does not change *how well* those scores track actual coding skill.

Specification:

Hiring Evaluation Score (Z) $\sim$ True Coding Ability (Z) $\times$ 1[Blind arm] | Respondent FE + Display Position FE.

- $H_0: \beta = 0$ — the evaluator extracts *no signal* from true coding ability.
- $H_0: \beta = 1$ — the evaluator is *perfectly calibrated*: a 1 SD rise in true ability produces exactly a 1 SD rise in the rating, with no shrinkage.

	HR	Engineer
$\hat{\beta}_{\text{nonblind}}$ (slope, nonblind arm)	0.377 (0.029)	0.886 (0.012)
$\hat{\beta}_{\text{blind}}$ (slope, blind arm)	0.357 (0.023)	0.856 (0.015)
Observations	2,466	2,772
R^2	0.142	0.759
Adj. R^2	0.085	0.743
Resume (Content) FE	×	×
Display Position FE	✓	✓
Respondent FE	✓	✓
Respondent Characteristics	×	×

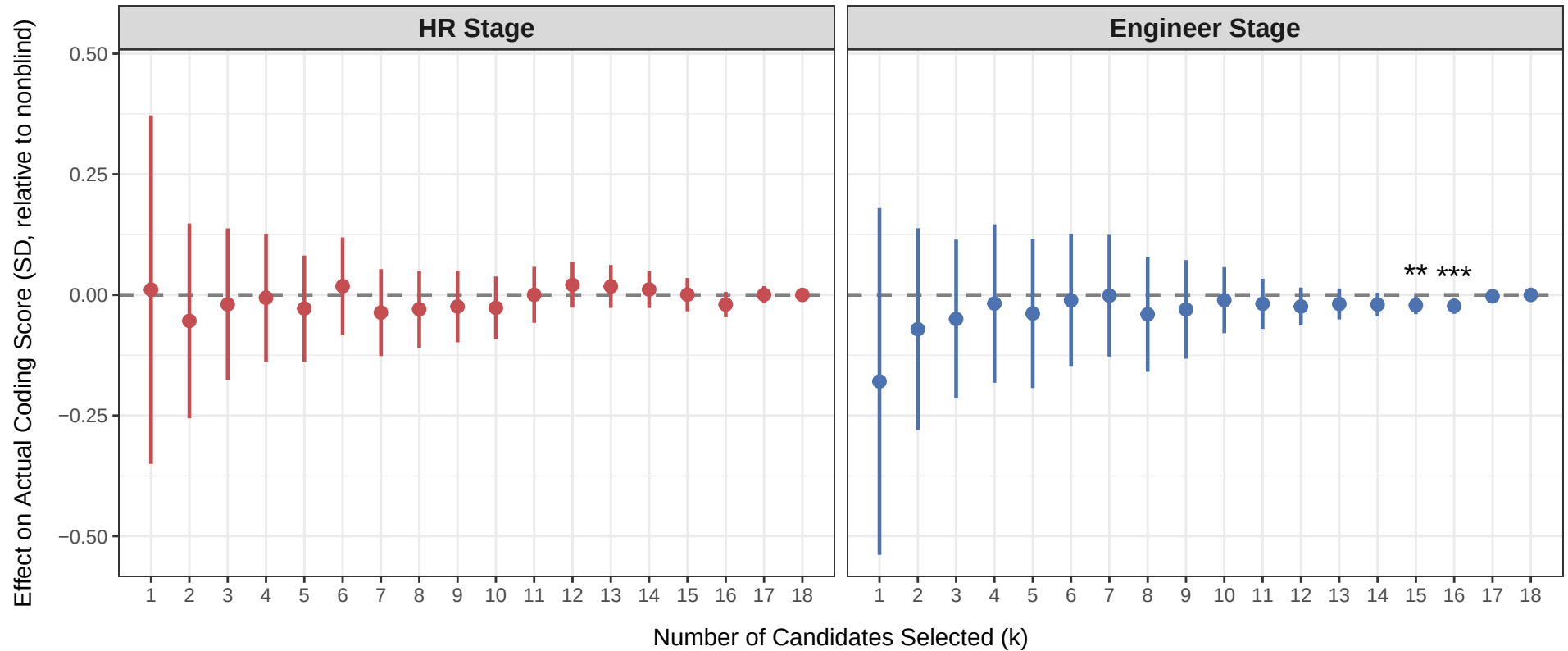


Cluster-robust standard errors (by respondent) shown in parentheses next to each $\hat{\beta}$. Stars on p-values: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. *Note:* Both arm-specific slopes come from a single pooled interacted regression per role, `sc_coding_z ~ true_coding_z * i(treat, ref = 'nonblind')` | `responseid + r_do`; $\hat{\beta}_{\text{nonblind}}$ is read off the main coefficient, and $\hat{\beta}_{\text{blind}}$ is computed as (main + interaction) with SE derived via the standard linear-combination formula using the estimated variance-covariance matrix. The “Resume (Content) FE” row is marked as not included because `overall_score` is a resume-level property (one lab score per resume), so a resume-content FE would absorb the RHS and leave the main slope unidentified. “Respondent Characteristics” is marked as not included because respondent-level variables (age, gender, race, education, income) are all perfectly collinear with the respondent FE and therefore absorbed by it.

5.2 Does Blind Hiring Select Better Coders?

Does Blind Hiring Select Better Coders?

Effect of blinding on actual coding quality of selected candidates. Standardized relative to nonblind group at each k.



Positive = blind hiring selects candidates with higher actual coding scores.

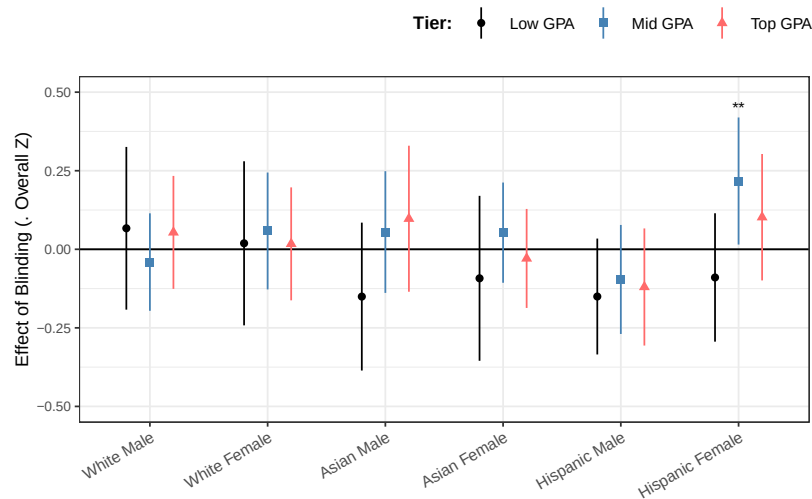
Significance: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

6 Heterogeneity in Treatment Effects by Candidate Quality (Appendix)

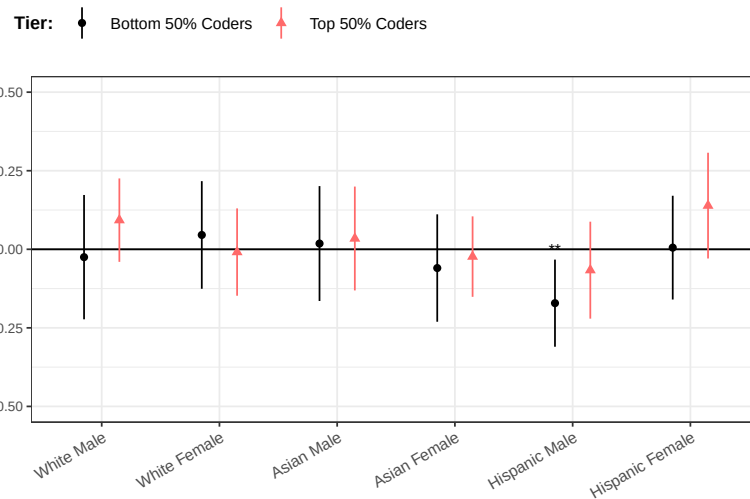
The §2 demographic-effect regression run on subsamples by candidate quality. Three cuts: per-cell (6 race-gender groups), URM-tech (URM = WF+AF+HM+HF vs Non-URM = WM+AM), and URM-axis (Male non-Hispanic / Female non-Hispanic / Hispanic). Two splits per cut: GPA tier (Low / Mid / Top) and Coding tier (Bottom / Top half on `test_case`). LHS sign-flipped so positive $\Rightarrow$ blinding raises the score.

HR Evaluators

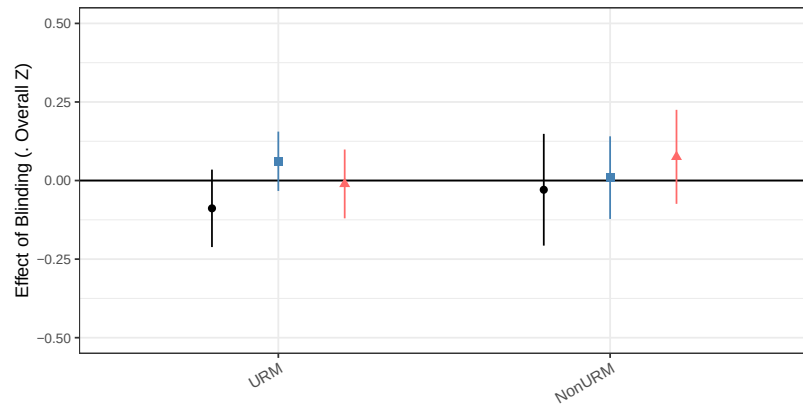
HR: Per-Cell, by GPA



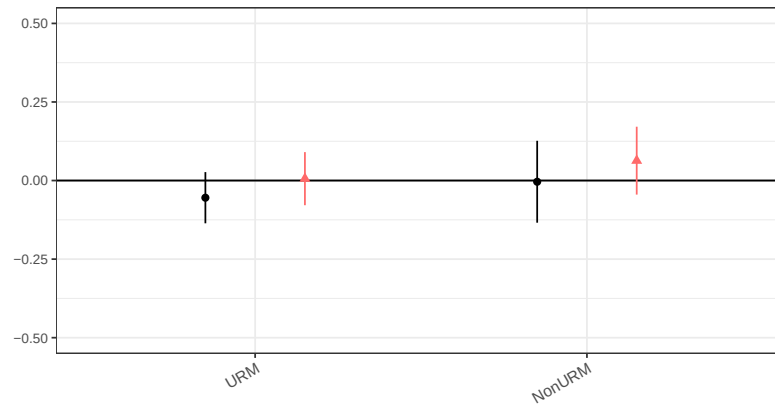
HR: Per-Cell, by Coding



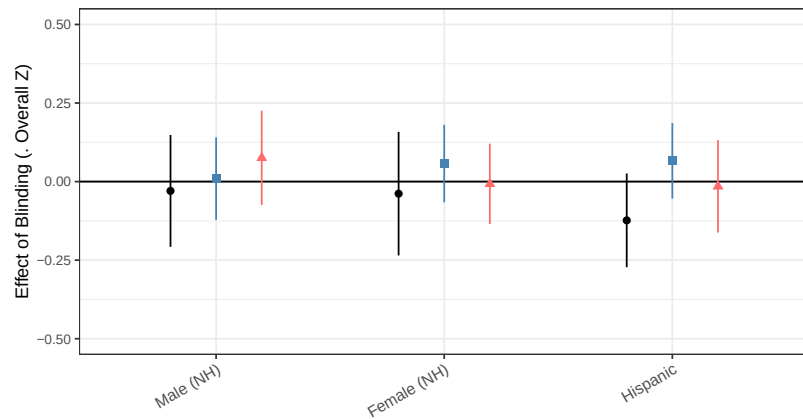
HR: URM-tech, by GPA



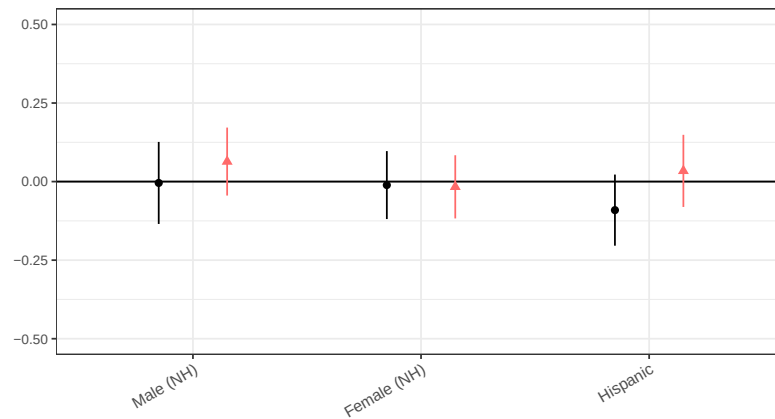
HR: URM-tech, by Coding



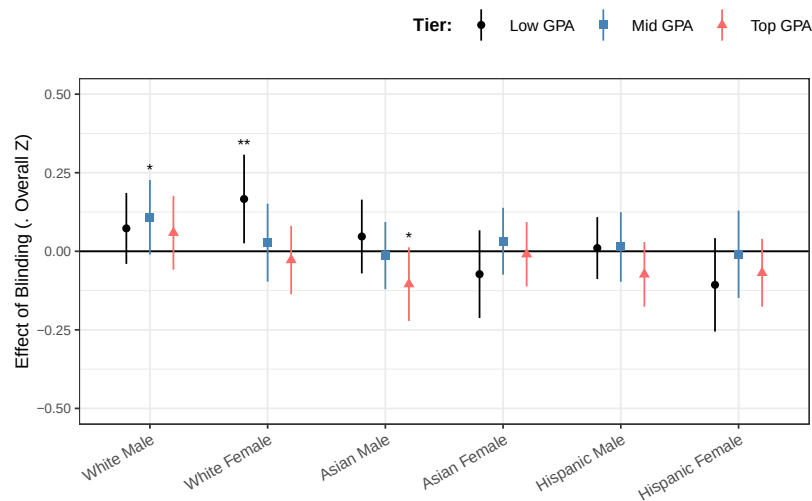
HR: URM-axis, by GPA



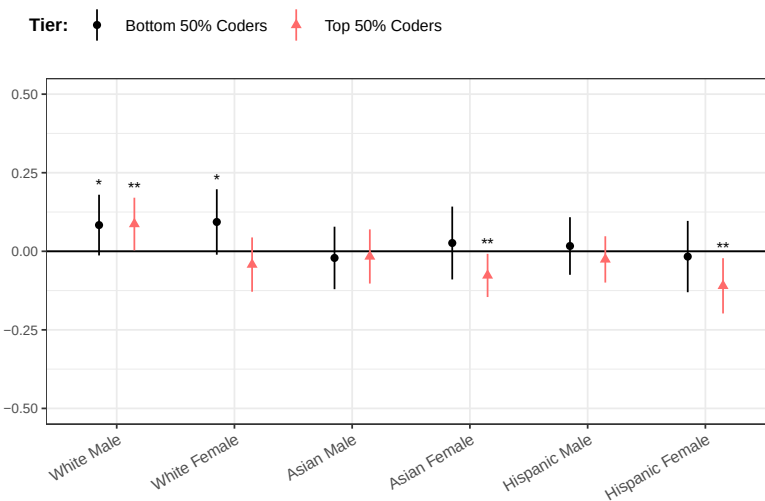
HR: URM-axis, by Coding



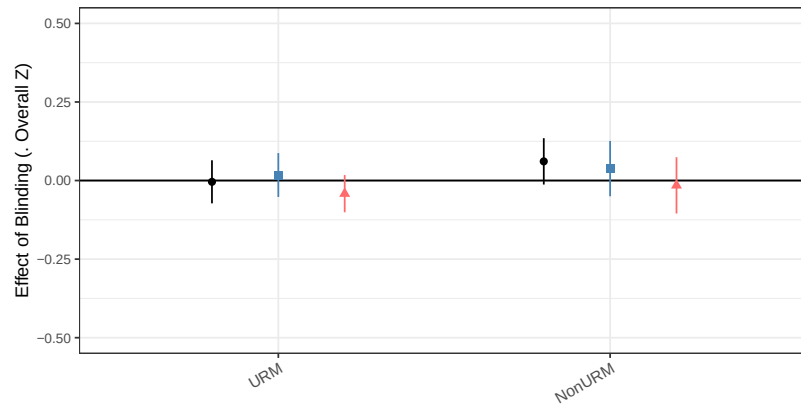
Eng: Per-Cell, by GPA



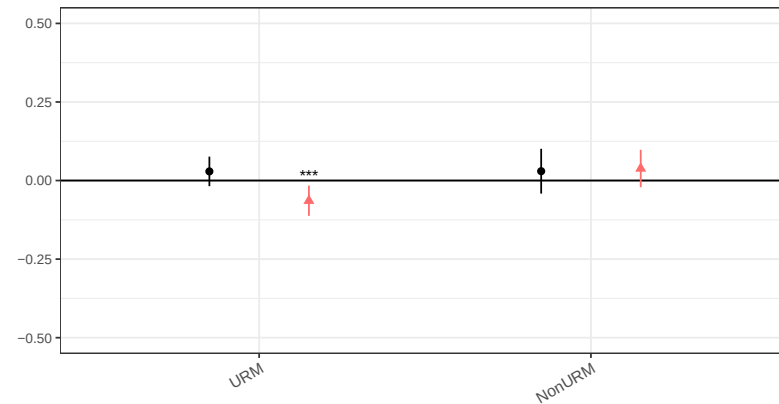
Eng: Per-Cell, by Coding



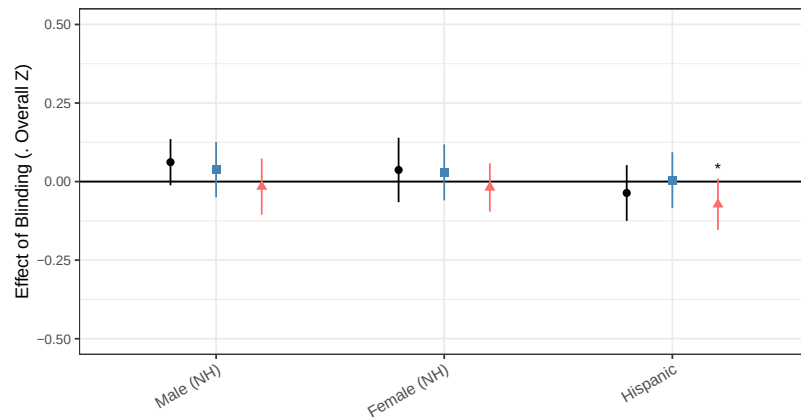
Eng: URM-tech, by GPA



Eng: URM-tech, by Coding



Eng: URM-axis, by GPA



Eng: URM-axis, by Coding

